

DEADLY PASS Counter terror operations after an army convoy was ambushed in Kathua, Jul. 9

Riyaz Ahmad and Mudasir Hussain, who they suspect may be aiding the "foreign terrorists". "They can't roam the jungles without local guides," says a retired senior police officer who served in Doda in the late 1990s. "Many young people from Doda's villages crossed to PoK in the 1990s and there is a possibility they may have returned to act as guides to the foreigners now." J&K police sources say local support has grown again for the militants. At present, it is estimated that close to 300 overground workers (OGW) are active in J&K.

Meanwhile, the security establishment has been in a huddle in New Delhi and Jammu to chalk out a plan for a counter-terror offensive. The heads of the security forces, including army chief Gen. Upendra Dwivedi, and intelligence agencies reviewed the situation at a July 20 meeting in Jammu. Chaired by J&K Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha, it called for a "full throttle response" to the attacks. Later, speaking at an event in Srinagar, the L-G said the counter-terrorism strategy adopted in Kashmir would be extended to Jammu. "We will not allow the revival of terrorism in Jammu at any cost...we'll adopt the Kashmir model to wipe it out," he said.

A brigade-level force has been deployed in Jammu, boosting the counter-insurgency operations in the region in the past week. It includes three battalions of an infantry brigade (3,000 troops) and a few teams of special forces (500 troops). This is in addition to the already existing structures, including the Romeo and Delta units of the Rashtriya Rifles (RR) as well as the 25 and 26 Infantry



"SOME PRESSURE MUST BE PUT ON PAKISTAN, BE IT BY REVISITING THE CEASEFIRE (ALONG THE LoC) OR CARRYING OUT OVERT/ COVERT ACTIONS"

LT GEN. D.S. HOODA (RETD)
Former Northern Army commander